

Lockheed Martin and MBDA Confirm F-35 / ASRAAM Integration Milestone

Lockheed Martin and MBDA today announced the successful completion of flight-test integration of the ASRAAM short-range air-to-air missile onto the F-35 Lightning II stealth fighter, marking a significant expansion of the aircraft's within-visual-range capability.

Under the programme, the F-35 has been cleared to carry and employ the infrared-guided ASRAAM from its external wing stations, with the missile integrated into the aircraft's sensor-fusion and cueing architecture. A series of guided firings against representative aerial targets validated the F-35 / ASRAAM weapon pairing across the engagement envelope.

Officials described the ASRAAM integration onto the F-35 as providing operators with a high-off-boresight dogfight missile that complements the beyond-visual-range weapons already carried internally. Deliveries of the integrated capability to F-35 operators are expected to follow operational test.